

Word family: **power / powerful / powerfully / powerless / powerlessness / empower / empowered / empowerment**

Base word: power

Related forms: powerful, powerfully, powerless, powerlessness, empower, empowered, empowerment

Useful expressions / extensions: powerful effect, powerful influence, powerful argument, powerful person, powerful engine, political power, purchasing power, electrical power

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun, adverb, and verb family (相關名詞、副詞及動詞)

Your sentence:

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply **powerful**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **powerful** means **capable of having a strong and meaningful effect on other people**.

It does **not** mean physically strong or politically powerful.

The speaker means that quiet, consistent kindness can influence people deeply, give them emotional support, and remain important in their lives.

繁體中文：**能對別人的情感、思想或生活產生深刻而強烈影響的；很有感染力和影響力的**

中文翻譯：

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

「善良可以很安靜、很穩定，卻也具有非常**深刻而強大的影響力**。」

Here:

powerful kindness = 雖然不張揚，卻能深深影響、支持和感動別人的善意

1. **powerful = having a strong effect/influence (影響力) — 很有力量的；影響深遠的**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply **powerful**.”

「善良可以很安靜、很穩定，卻也具有非常**強大的影響力**。」

Practice 2

> “A few kind words can be surprisingly **powerful**.”

「幾句善意的話可以有出乎意料地**強大而深刻的影響**。」

Practice 3

> “Her example had a **powerful** effect on me.”

「她的榜樣對我產生了**非常深刻的影響**。」

****powerful = 能對人的思想、感情、行為或結果產生強烈影響****

2. ****powerful + person/group (權力 / 影響力) — 有權勢的；有影響力的****

A major meaning.

Practice 4

> “He became one of the most **powerful** people in the company.”

「他成為公司裡最**有權力 / 影響力**的人之一。」

Practice 5

> “The organization has several **powerful** supporters.”

「這個組織得到幾位**很有影響力的支持者**支持。」

****powerful person/group = 擁有很大權力、地位、資源或能力去影響其他人的人 / 群體****

3. ****powerful country/organization (勢力強大的) — 強大的；有實力的****

Practice 6

> “It became a **powerful** trading nation.”

「它成為一個**實力強大的貿易國家**。」

Practice 7

> “The company grew into a **powerful** global organization.”

「公司發展成一個**實力雄厚**的全球組織。」

powerful = 在經濟、政治、軍事、商業或其他領域擁有大量力量和影響力的

4. **powerful** = physically strong / forceful (物理力量) — 強大的 ; 有力的

Practice 8

> “The animal has **powerful** legs.”

「這種動物有非常**強而有力**的腿。」

Practice 9

> “A **powerful** wave knocked him over.”

「一股**強勁**的海浪把他沖倒了。」

powerful = 能產生很大物理力量或衝擊力的

5. **powerful engine/machine** (機械) — 動力強勁的 ; 高性能的

Practice 10

> “The car has a very **powerful engine**.”

「這輛車有一個**動力非常強勁**的引擎。」

Practice 11

> “You need a more **powerful** computer for this software.”

「這套軟件需要一部性能更**強大的電腦**。」

powerful machine/device = 能產生較大輸出、運算能力或工作效能的機器 / 裝置

6. **powerful tool/technology** (工具 / 科技) — 功能強大的；非常有效的

Practice 12

> “The internet is a **powerful tool** for learning.”

「互聯網是一個非常強大的學習工具。」

Practice 13

> “This software provides **powerful** editing features.”

「這套軟件提供非常強大的編輯功能。」

powerful tool/technology = 能完成很多事情、產生顯著效果或大幅提升能力的工具 / 科技

7. **powerful argument/evidence** (論據 / 證據) — 有力的；極具說服力的

Practice 14

> “She made a **powerful argument** for change.”

「她提出了一個非常有力、有說服力的論點。」

Practice 15

> “The study provides **powerful evidence**.”

「這項研究提供了非常有力的證據。」

powerful argument/evidence = 能強烈支持某個結論並具有高度說服力的

8. **powerful message/story/speech** (訊息 / 故事) — 有感染力的；震撼人心的

Practice 16

> “The film sends a **powerful message** about family.”

「這部電影傳達了一個非常有感染力的家庭訊息。」

Practice 17

> “It was a **powerful story** about forgiveness.”

「那是一個關於寬恕、非常**感人而有力量**的故事。」

powerful = 能引起強烈感情、思考或反應的

9. **powerful emotion/feeling** (情緒) — 強烈的

Practice 18

> “She felt a **powerful** sense of relief.”

「她感到一種非常**強烈的安心感**。」

Practice 19

> “Love can be a **powerful emotion**.”

「愛可以是一種非常**強烈的情感**。」

powerful emotion = 程度非常高、很難忽視的情感

10. **powerful memory/image** (記憶 / 形象) — 鮮明深刻的；震撼的

Practice 20

> “The photograph created a **powerful image**.”

「這張照片形成了一個非常**鮮明而震撼的形象**。」

Practice 21

> “The experience left a **powerful memory**.”

「這次經歷留下了一段非常**深刻的記憶**。」

powerful = 對人的記憶或感受造成深刻而持久的影響

11. **powerful smell/taste** (氣味 / 味道) — 濃烈的；強烈的

Practice 22

> “The cheese has a **powerful smell**.”

「這種芝士有非常**濃烈的氣味**。」

Practice 23

> “The sauce has a **powerful flavour**.”

「這種醬汁的味道非常**濃烈**。」

powerful = 感官刺激的強度非常高，很容易被察覺

In ordinary English, **strong smell/flavour** is often more common.

12. **powerful medicine/drug** (藥物) — 藥效強的

Practice 24

> “This is a **powerful painkiller**.”

「這是一種**藥效很強的止痛藥**。」

Practice 25

> “The medicine can have **powerful effects** on the body.”

「這種藥物可能對身體產生**很強的作用**。」

powerful medicine = 能在身體上產生強烈藥理作用的藥物

13. **power** = ability to control/influence (權力) — 權力；控制力

The central noun meaning.

Practice 26

> “The manager has the **power** to make the final decision.”

「經理有**權力**作最後決定。」

Practice 27

> “Too much **power** can be dangerous.”

「過多的**權力**可能很危險。」

power = 控制事情、作決定或影響別人行動的能力 / 權力

14. **power** = political/government authority (政權 / 政治權力) — 權力 ; 執政權

Practice 28

> “The new government came to **power**.”

「新政府**上台執政**。」

Practice 29

> “The party remained in **power** for ten years.”

「該政黨**執政**了十年。」

power = 政治制度中控制政府、制定政策和作重大決策的權力

15. **power** = physical strength/force (力量) — 力量 ; 力氣

Practice 30

> “The athlete hit the ball with great **power**.”

「運動員以很大的**力量**擊球。」

Practice 31

> “The storm increased in **power**.”

「暴風雨的**威力**增強了。」

power = 能產生動作、衝擊或物理效果的力量

16. **power** = energy/electricity (能源 / 電力) — 電力 ; 動力

A major modern meaning.

Practice 32

> “The storm caused a **power** failure.”

「暴風雨造成**停電**。」

Practice 33

> “The building lost **power**.”

「大樓失去**電力供應**。」

power = 供應機器、建築或設備運作所需的電力 / 能源

17. **power** = machine output (功率) — 功率 ; 動力

Practice 34

> “The engine produces more **power**.”

「這個引擎能產生更大的**功率 / 動力**。」

Practice 35

> “The device uses very little **power**.”

「這部裝置耗用很少**電力**。」

power = 機械或電氣系統產生 / 消耗能量的能力或速率

18. **power** = ability/capacity (能力) — 能力 ; 力量

A broad figurative meaning.

Practice 36

> “Words have the **power** to change how people think.”

「言語具有改變人們思想的**力量**。」

Practice 37

> “Kindness has the **power** to comfort people.”

「善良具有安慰別人的**力量**。」

****power = 令某件事情發生、改變或產生效果的能力****

This noun meaning is especially close to your passage.

19. ****the power of + idea/love/kindness (某事物的力量) — 影響力 ; 力量****

Practice 38

> “The book explores the **power of kindness**.”

「這本書探討**善良的力量**。」

Practice 39

> “Never underestimate the **power of a simple gesture**.”

「不要低估一個簡單舉動的**力量 / 影響力**。」

****the power of something = 某事物產生改變、影響或效果的能力****

20. ****purchasing/buying power (購買力) — 購買力****

A common economic expression.

Practice 40

> “Inflation reduces consumers’ purchasing **power**.”

「通脹會降低消費者的**購買力**。」

Practice 41

> “Higher wages increased household buying **power**.”

「較高工資提升了家庭的**購買力**。」

****purchasing power = 某筆收入 / 貨幣實際能購買多少商品和服務的能力****

21. ****computing power (運算能力) — 運算能力****

Practice 42

> “Modern phones have enormous computing ****power****.”

「現代手機擁有很強的****運算能力****。」

Practice 43

> “The system requires more processing ****power****.”

「這個系統需要更高的****處理 / 運算能力****。」

****computing power = 電腦 / 處理器進行計算和處理資料的能力****

22. ****powerfully = with great force/effect (強烈地 ; 有力地) ****

The main adverb form.

Practice 44

> “The story ****powerfully**** expresses the importance of family.”

「這個故事****很有感染力地****表達家庭的重要性。」

Practice 45

> “She spoke ****powerfully**** about her experience.”

「她以非常****有力量、有感染力的方式****談自己的經歷。」

****powerfully = 以產生強烈影響、力量或情感效果的方式****

23. ****powerless = lacking power/control (無力的) — 無力的 ; 無權的****

The main negative form.

Practice 46

> “He felt **powerless** to change the situation.”

「他覺得自己**無力改變這個情況**。」

Practice 47

> “The workers were **powerless** to stop the decision.”

「工人們**無權 / 無力阻止**這個決定。」

powerless = 沒有足夠能力、權力或控制力去影響事情

24. **powerlessness** = state of lacking control (無力感) — 無力；無助感

Practice 48

> “The situation gave her a sense of **powerlessness**.”

「這個情況令她產生一種**無力感**。」

Practice 49

> “People can experience **powerlessness** when they have no control over major decisions.”

「當人無法控制重大決定時，可能產生**無助 / 無力感**。」

powerlessness = 缺乏控制、影響或改變情況能力的狀態

25. **empower** = give power/control/confidence (賦權) — 賦權；使更有能力

A very useful family extension.

Practice 50

> “Education can **empower** people.”

「教育可以**賦予人們更多能力和自主權**。」

Practice 51

> “Good leaders **empower** their teams to make decisions.”

「好的領導者會**授權**團隊作決定。」

empower = 給予某人更多權力、資源、信心或實際能力，使其能自行行動 / 作決定

26. **empowered** = feeling capable/in control (有自主能力的) — 感到有能力 / 有自主權的

Practice 52

> “She felt more **empowered** after learning the necessary skills.”

「學會所需技能後，她感到自己**更有能力和自主權**。」

Practice 53

> “Employees feel **empowered** when their ideas are taken seriously.”

「當員工的意見受到重視時，他們會感到自己**更有參與和決策能力**。」

empowered = 擁有或感受到足夠能力、權力和信心去採取行動的

27. **empowerment** = gaining power/control (賦權 / 自主能力提升) — 賦權；自主權提升

Practice 54

> “The programme focuses on community **empowerment**.”

「這項計劃著重社區**賦權 / 提升自主能力**。」

Practice 55

> “Education can contribute to personal **empowerment**.”

「教育有助促進個人**自主能力和掌控感的提升**。」

empowerment = 使個人 / 群體獲得更多能力、資源、信心或決策權的過程

Important distinction: **powerful vs strong**

These overlap heavily, but they are not identical.

strong

has a very broad range:

- * strong person
- * strong coffee
- * strong smell
- * strong relationship
- * strong argument

powerful

usually emphasizes:

> the ability to produce a major effect, force, or influence.

Compare:

> **a strong person**

> = 身體強壯 / 意志堅強

> **a powerful person**

> = 有權勢 / 有巨大影響力的人

And:

> **strong coffee** 

is much more natural than:

> **powerful coffee**

So **strong** has broader everyday collocations.

Important distinction: **powerful vs influential**

influential

specifically means:

> able to influence people's decisions, opinions, or events.

****powerful****

is broader and can refer to:

- * physical force
- * political authority
- * emotional impact
- * machines
- * medicine
- * arguments

A powerful person is often influential, but the words are not identical.

Important distinction: ****powerful vs effective****

****effective****

means:

> successfully produces the intended result.

****powerful****

means:

> produces a strong or substantial effect.

Something can be powerful but not appropriate/effective for a particular purpose.

For example:

> a powerful medicine

may have a strong effect,

but another treatment may be:

> more effective

for a specific condition.

Important distinction: **powerful vs forceful**

powerful

focuses on strength/effect.

forceful

often describes:

> a person's speech, manner, argument, or personality as strongly expressed.

> “a forceful speaker”

= 說話非常有力、強勢的人

A **powerful speech** focuses on its effect on the audience.

Important distinction: **powerful vs dominant**

powerful

= possesses great ability, force, authority, or influence.

dominant

= stronger/more important than **others in the same situation**.

A company may be powerful without dominating its market.

Dominant introduces an explicit relative position.

Important distinction: **power vs strength**

strength

often means:

* physical force

* resilience

* strong quality

* advantage

power

often means:

* control

* authority

* ability to cause effects

* energy

Compare:

> physical strength

> = 體力 / 肌力

> political power

> = 政治權力

Important distinction: **power vs authority**

power

is broad:

> actual ability to control or influence.

authority

often means:

> officially recognized right to make decisions or give orders.

Someone can have informal power without formal authority.

Important distinction: **power vs influence**

power

can directly control outcomes.

influence

means affecting outcomes or opinions without necessarily controlling them.

Your passage's:

> **powerful kindness**

is closer to **deep influence** than formal power.

Important distinction: **powerful effect vs strong effect**

Both are natural.

strong effect

= effect is large/noticeable.

powerful effect

often adds a stronger sense of:

> emotional force, impact, or ability to cause significant change.

The difference is subtle and context-dependent.

Important distinction: **powerful person vs physically powerful person**

Without context:

> **a powerful person**

often suggests:

> influential / high-status / able to control events.

If you mean bodily force, English often prefers:

> **physically powerful**

or:

> **very strong**.

Important distinction: **powerful message vs important message**

important message

= the content matters.

powerful message

= it strongly affects, persuades, or moves people.

So **powerful** describes impact, not merely importance.

Important distinction: **powerless vs weak**

weak

can mean:

- * physically weak
- * structurally weak
- * unconvincing
- * low intensity

powerless

specifically means:

> lacking ability/control/authority to change what happens.

Someone can be physically strong but politically powerless.

Important distinction: **empower vs help**

help

= assist someone.

empower

= give them greater **capacity, control, confidence, resources, or authority to act themselves**.

So empowerment is not simply doing something for someone; it emphasizes enabling their own agency.

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **power / powerful** family:

- * **powerful — strong effect** = 具有強大 / 深刻影響力的
- * **powerful person/group** = 有權勢 / 影響力的
- * **powerful country/organization** = 實力強大的
- * **powerful — physical force** = 力量強大的
- * **powerful engine/computer** = 動力 / 性能強大的
- * **powerful tool/technology** = 功能強大、效果顯著的
- * **powerful argument/evidence** = 有力而具說服力的
- * **powerful message/story** = 有感染力 / 震撼力的
- * **powerful emotion** = 強烈的情感
- * **powerful medicine** = 藥效強的
- * **power — authority/control** = 權力 / 控制力
- * **power — political** = 政權 / 政治權力
- * **power — physical** = 力量 / 威力
- * **power — electricity/energy** = 電力 / 能源
- * **power — capacity** = 產生改變或效果的能力
- * **the power of something** = 某事物的力量 / 影響力
- * **purchasing power** = 購買力
- * **computing power** = 運算能力
- * **powerfully** = 有力地 / 強烈地
- * **powerless** = 無力 / 無權的
- * **powerlessness** = 無力感
- * **empower** = 賦權 / 使有能力
- * **empowered** = 感到有能力和自主權的
- * **empowerment** = 賦權 / 自主能力提升

Following the reference approach, these should be organized around genuinely different concepts —**control, physical force, energy, capacity, and strong effect**—while ordinary collocational differences within one concept should not be over-split.

Master comparison

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powerful — strong effect/influence	能對人的思想、情感、行為或結果產生強烈而深刻影響的
powerful — person/group	擁有很大權力、地位、資源或影響力的
powerful — country/organization	在政治、經濟、商業等方面具有很強實力和影響力的
powerful — physical force	能產生很大物理力量或衝擊力的
powerful engine/machine	能產生很大動力、輸出或運算能力的
powerful tool/technology	功能或能力很強，能產生顯著效果的
powerful argument/evidence	能強烈支持某個結論並具有高度說服力的
powerful message/story	能引起強烈感情、思考或反應的
powerful emotion	程度非常高、難以忽視的情感
powerful medicine	能在身體上產生強烈藥理作用的
power — authority/control	控制事情、作決定或影響別人行動的能力 / 權力
power — political authority	控制政府、制定政策或作重大決策的政治權力
power — physical force	能產生動作、衝擊或物理效果的力量
power — electricity/energy	供機器、建築或設備運作所需的電力 / 能源
power — machine output	機械 / 電氣系統產生或使用能量的能力 / 功率
power — capacity	令某件事情發生、改變或產生效果的能力
the power of something	某事物產生影響、改變或效果的能力
purchasing power	收入 / 貨幣實際可購買商品和服務的能力
computing power	電腦或處理器進行計算和處理資料的能力
powerfully	以能產生強烈力量、影響或情感效果的方式
powerless	沒有足夠能力、權力或控制力去改變事情的
powerlessness	缺乏控制、影響或改變情況能力的狀態 / 感受
empower	給予某人更多能力、資源、信心或決策權，使其能自行行動
empowered	擁有或感受到足夠能力、權力和信心採取行動的
empowerment	個人 / 群體獲得更多自主能力、資源、信心或決策權的過程

For your original sentence

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply ****powerful****.”

The exact meaning is:

****powerful = 能產生深刻、持久而強烈的情感或人生影響****

Therefore:

> ****deeply powerful kindness****

= ****「看似安靜低調，卻能深深影響、支持和感動別人的善意」****

This is a particularly important nuance because the passage deliberately rejects the idea that

something must be:

- > loud
- > dramatic
- > forceful

in order to be:

- > **powerful**

Your grandmother's kindness is powerful because it is:

- > quiet
- > steady
- > accepting
- > patient
- > consistently expressed through small actions

So here **powerful** is about **impact**, not physical strength, authority, or control.